

NOVAHR

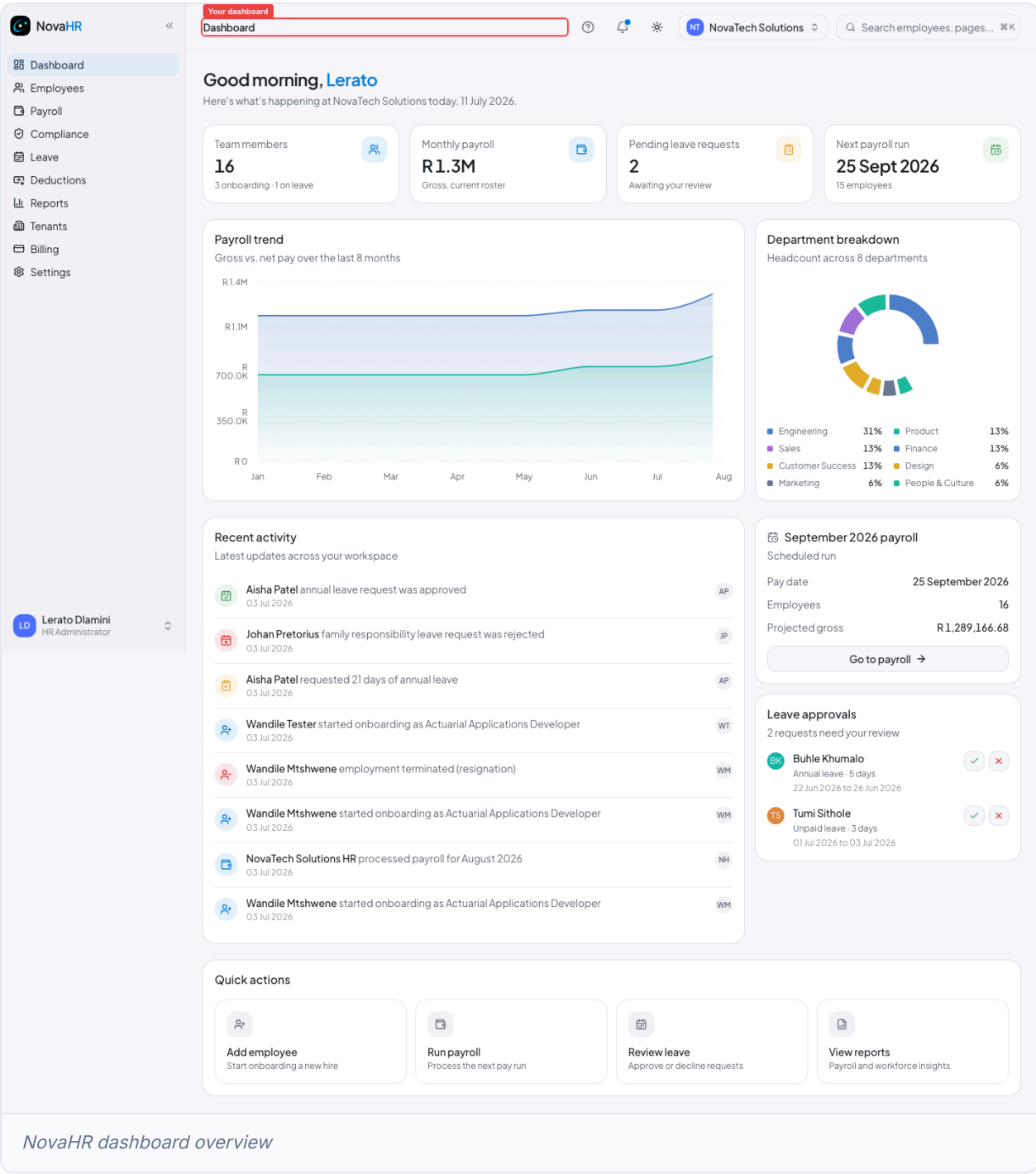
HR and Payroll, Built for South African Business

Onboarding Guide

Setting up NovaHR for your company

hello@novahr.co.za | novahr-five.vercel.app

NovaHR Onboarding Guide



Audience: New customers (HR Administrators and business owners) **Timeline:** Designed as a 2-week path from sign-up to first live payroll.

How Onboarding Works

Phase	Days	Outcome
1. Foundation	1-2	Company configured, structure created
2. Data	3-7	All employees captured and verified
3. Verification	8-11	Test payroll run checked against your current payroll
4. Go-live	12-14	First live run approved and published

Growth and Scale plans include a live onboarding session; book it via hello@novahr.co.za.

Phase 1: Foundation (Days 1-2)

The screenshot displays the NovaHR Settings interface. On the left is a sidebar with navigation links: Dashboard, Employees, Payroll, Compliance, Leave, Deductions, Reports, Tenants, Billing, and Settings (highlighted). The main content area is titled 'Settings' with a subtitle 'Manage your company profile, payroll configuration and leave policies.' Below this are tabs for Company, Users, Departments, Payroll, Leave policies, Notifications, Appearance, and Audit log. The 'Company profile' section is active, showing fields for Company name (NovaTech Solutions), Legal name (NovaTech Solutions (Pty) Ltd), Industry (Software & Technology), Founded (2018), Registration number (2018/123456/07), VAT number (4480123456), City (Cape Town), Primary contact (Lerato Dlamini), and Registered address (12 Bree Street, Cape Town, 8001). A 'Save changes' button is at the bottom right. Below the company profile is the 'Employee numbering' section. At the bottom of the page, a message reads 'Company settings: complete your profile'.

- ☐ Accept the Terms of Service and Data Processing Agreement (account owner);
- ☐ Complete company profile (Settings, Company);
- ☐ Capture PAYE, UIF, SDL reference numbers (Settings, Payroll);
- ☐ Confirm SDL liability (annual payroll above R500,000?);

- ☐ Set pay frequency and pay day;
- ☐ Configure leave policies (defaults are BCEA minimums; align to your contracts);
- ☐ Create departments and positions.

Phase 2: Data (Days 3-7)

Employees
Manage your team's profiles, roles and onboarding progress.

16 Total employees | 12 Active | 3 Onboarding | 8 Departments

Search by name, role or email... | All departments | Active | ☐ Show terminated

Employee	Department	Status	Type	Location	Annual salary	Onboarding
Aisha Patel Senior Software Engineer	Engineering	Active	Full-time	Cape Town, HQ	R 950.0K	-
Buhle Khumalo Account Executive	Sales	Active	Full-time	Cape Town, HQ	R 580.0K	-
Craig Adams Head of Sales	Sales	Active	Full-time	Cape Town, HQ	R 1.5M	-
Johan Pretorius Software Engineer	Engineering	Active	Full-time	Cape Town, HQ	R 650.0K	-
Kabelo Modise Head of Customer Success	Customer Success	Active	Full-time	Cape Town, HQ	R 1.1M	-
Lerato Dlamini Chief People Officer	People & Culture	Active	Full-time	Cape Town, HQ	R 1.4M	-
Michelle van Wyk Head of Marketing	Marketing	Active	Full-time	Cape Town, HQ	R 1.1M	-
Ryan Govender Head of Product	Product	Active	Full-time	Cape Town, HQ	R 1.4M	-
Thabo Nkosi VP of Engineering	Engineering	Active	Full-time	Cape Town, HQ	R 1.6M	-
Tumi Sithole Payroll Administrator	Finance	Active	Full-time	Cape Town, HQ	R 420.0K	-
Werner Botha Finance Manager	Finance	Active	Full-time	Cape Town, HQ	R 900.0K	-
Zanele Mthembu Head of Design	Design	Active	Full-time	Cape Town, HQ	R 1.1M	-

Employee list: add your team

- ☐ Gather source data (use the Payroll Setup Guide checklist);
- ☐ Capture every active employee: identity, employment, pay, banking, leave balances;
- ☐ Verify the three fields that most often cause payslip errors:
 - Date of birth (drives age rebates),
 - Medical aid dependant count (drives tax credits),
 - Travel allowance inclusion rate (80% default; 20% only with logbook substantiation);
- ☐ Set opening leave balances as at your cut-over date;
- ☐ Invite managers and employees; assign roles.

Phase 3: Verification (Days 8-11)

- ☐ Create a test payroll run for the current period;
- ☐ **Parallel run:** compare every employee's PAYE, UIF, and net pay against your current payroll system or accountant's calculation;
- ☐ Investigate every difference: most trace to dependant counts, pension percentages, or allowance treatment;
- ☐ Have your accountant or tax practitioner sign off one sample payslip;
- ☐ Read and acknowledge the Compliance Disclaimer and Customer Responsibilities;
- ☐ Confirm payslip email delivery (send yourself a test).

Phase 4: Go-Live (Days 12-14)

- ☐ Final data check: joiners, leavers, once-off items for the period;
- ☐ Run, review, and approve payroll;
- ☐ Publish payslips (employees are notified);
- ☐ Export the run report and archive it (SARS requires 5-year retention);
- ☐ Diarise statutory deadlines: EMP201 by the 7th, UI-19 monthly (see the SARS Compliance Calendar).

After Go-Live

- Month 2: run payroll without the parallel check but sample-verify 2-3 payslips;
- Review the audit log periodically (Settings, Audit Log);
- Send feedback and feature requests to hello@novahr.co.za;
- Every March: SARS updates tax tables; NovaHR ships the update and notifies you; verify your first March run.

Common Onboarding Pitfalls

1. **Wrong opening leave balances:** anchor to the cut-over date, not the calendar year;
2. **Missing income tax numbers:** capture them now, you need them for IRP5s;
3. **Medical aid captured as a deduction but dependants not set:** the deduction reduces net pay, dependants reduce tax; both matter;
4. **Publishing before verifying:** employees see published payslips immediately;
5. **Not exporting before cancelling an old system:** you must retain 5 years of history from your previous provider.